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‘Street takeover’ turns deadly at busy Compton intersection

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COMPTON—It’s a sunny Tuesday in June on the streets of Compton. As the summer heat creeps up, it is a normal, seemingly quiet afternoon. Except for the mad scribble of fresh black skidmarks scrawled across the intersection of Wilmington and Stockwell like the shadow of a discarded bouquet of flowers. The stench of an alleged street takeover late Sunday night remains rank in the air.

Except for the line of candles, balloons and flowers, the neighborhood around Wilmington and Stockwell is low-key; seeminglynormal. However, this day is anything but normal for the people, friends and loved ones of the two women who lost their lives in an alleged street takeover incident Sunday night.

Tracy Koerner of the Sheriff’s Information Bureau said the crash occurred around 11:40 p.m. Sunday at Wilmington Avenue and Stockwell Street, where witnesses said more than 200 people had gathered for a street takeover.

The pair who died, described only as females of unknown age, were inside a red sedan that collided with a silver SUV, according to sheriff’s officials and witnesses.

The driver of the SUV told reporters he was heading south on Wilmington and was going through a green light when the red sedan slammed into his vehicle. One report from the scene indicated the driver of the red car was spinning through the intersection as part of the street takeover, but sheriff’s officials said they were still investigating the circumstances of the crash.

Witnesses told reporters one of the female victims was thrown from the sedan and the other—possibly the driver—died inside the car. The SUV driver was not seriously injured.

The Compton Bulletin made several attempts to contact the Los Angele Sheriff’s Department Compton Station for a clear understanding of what took place. The Compton Sheriff’s Station stated there were not yet any press statements issued regarding the deadly incident.

Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel (D-Woodland Hills), has seen and heard enough. That is why Gabriel introduced legislation to crack down on illegal street racing and sideshows.

“Far too frequently, street racing and illegal sideshows devastate families, harm innocent bystanders, and cut short young lives,” said Gabriel. “Communities in the San Fernando Valley and across California are sick and tired of this reckless behavior. This bipartisan legislation will crack down on dangerous activity and help to save lives.”

According to a press statement released by Gabriel’s office, the illegal street takeovers and street racing incidents have seen an uptick since the beginning of the Covid-19 pandemic. In 2020, the California Highway Patrol (CHP) reportedly fielded at least 25,000 calls related to a street takeover.

Gabriel’s bill (AB 2000) is geared towards blocking all forms of illegal street racing in parking lots and street takeovers and banning sideshows related to these events. Other California lawmakers like Vince Fong (R-Kern County) are all on board with Gabriel’s bill.

“There are countless stories every week throughout California about illegal street races and dangerous sideshows shutting down streets, causing accidents, damaging neighborhoods, and endangering lives,” said Fong. “They are unpredictable, destructive, and can lead to senseless deaths that devastate families. AB 2000 is an important and

needed step in cracking down on illegal sideshows to make our communities safer and save lives.”

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